

1. SWOT ANALYSIS

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The SWOT analysis is produced using information from the case study, with some interesting points from our further analysis.

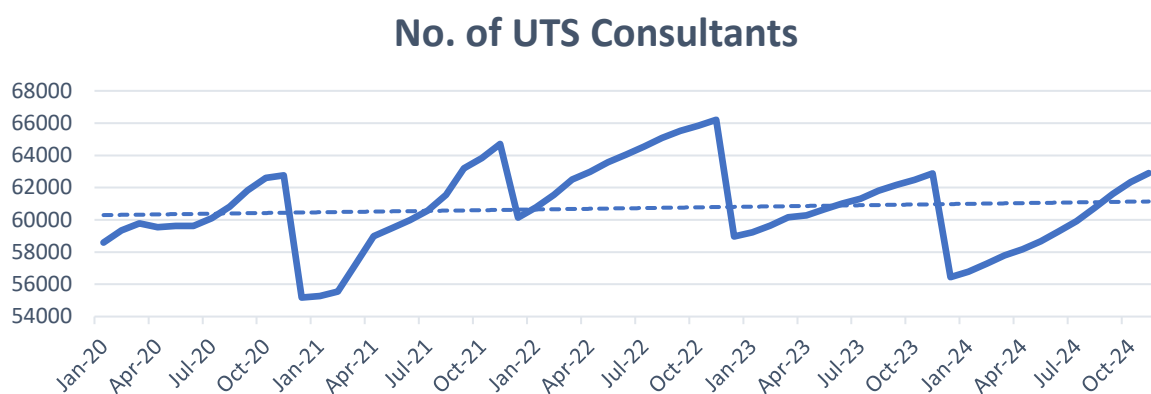
Weaknesses

The Instagram promotional reels are unattractive to younger and tech-savvy audiences because they emphasise different things. The younger audiences emphasise the advantages of being a UTC and the job's meaningfulness. Tech-savvy audiences emphasise the opportunities Eastspring provides them to review their talent. A promotional video without a differentiated strategy according to target audiences is inefficient.

Opportunities

The seasonal change in the number of UTC can be utilised as an opportunity for recruitment and to broaden the agency force [1]. Eastspring can reinforce recruitment advertisements following the cycle to expand the agency force.

[1] <https://www.fimm.com.my/industry/statistics/quick-statistic/#1656038704204-18d0fa68-c617>



Source: [1]

Threats

Eastspring performs better in short-term investment but is relatively weaker in medium-term and long-term investment [2]. It may be challenging for UTCs to attract and retain clients from certain groups, which narrows the scope of potential clients for UTCs.

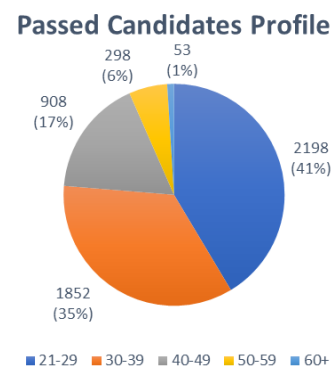
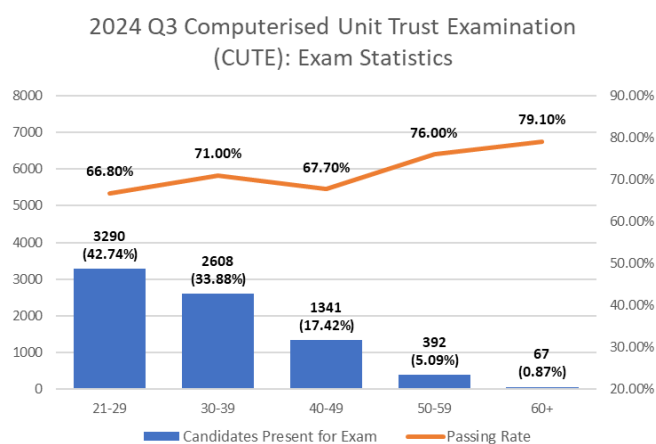
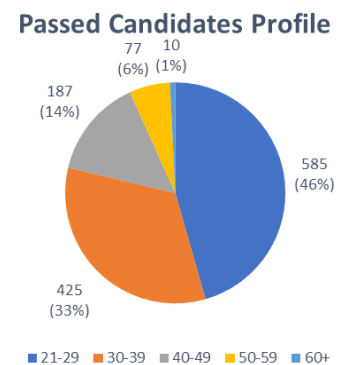
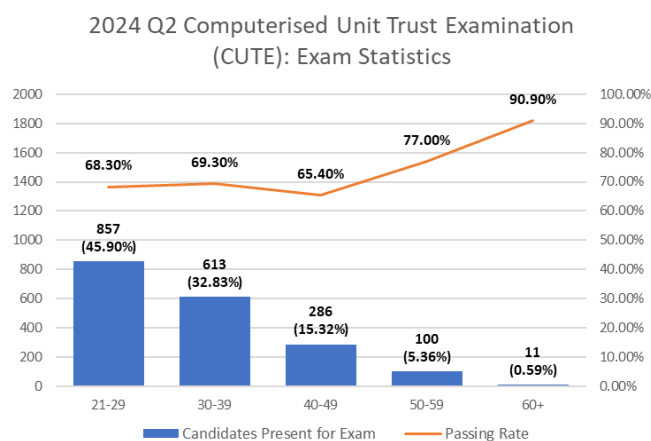
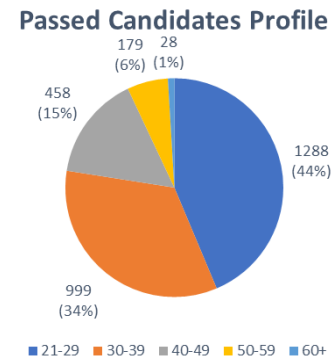
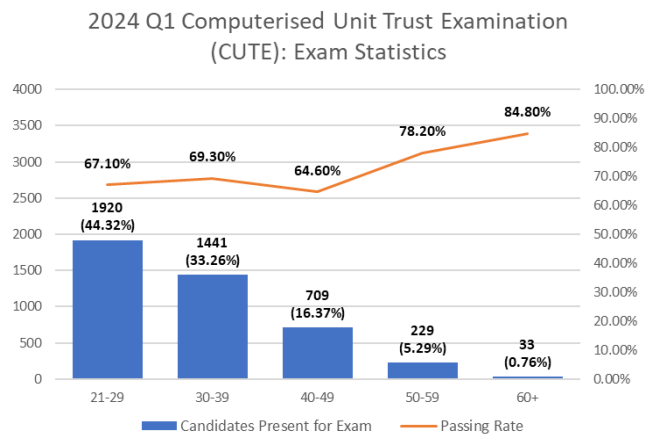
Among the top 5 unit trust companies by agency force, three are locals, and one is a joint venture with a local. Due to their brand recognition and public image, these competitors may have a better network in the Malaysian market. This better network can drag talent away from joining Eastspring.

No.	Competitors	Description
1.	Public Mutual Berhad	Local
2.	Kenanga Investors Berhad	Local
3.	Manulife Investment Management (M) Berhad	Multinational financial services company headquartered in Toronto, Canada
4.	RHB Asset Management Sdn Bhd	Local
5.	Principal Asset Management Berhad	Joint venture between Principal Financial Group and a CIMB Group

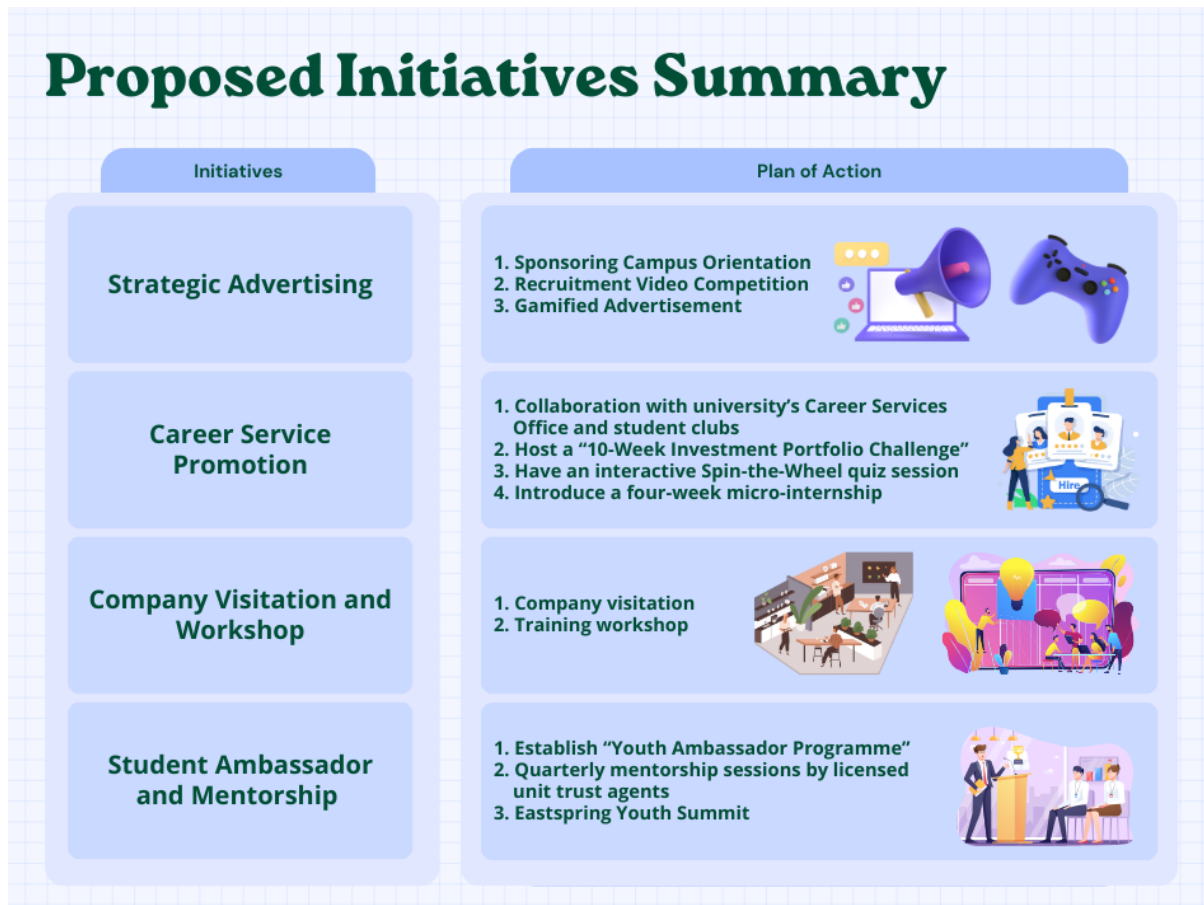
[1] <https://www.fimm.com.my/industry/statistics/quick-statistic/#1656038704204-18d0fa68-c617>

[2] <https://loanstreet.com.my/learning-centre/best-performing-unit-trust-funds-2024>

In 2024 Q1-Q3, most candidates that attend and pass CUTE are between the ages of 21 and 29, followed by 30-39 [3]. This means Eastspring's youth recruitment plan will face significant competition as its peers also focus their recruitment strategy on the same group.



2. PROPOSED INITIATIVES SUMMARY



3. MAIN CONTENT

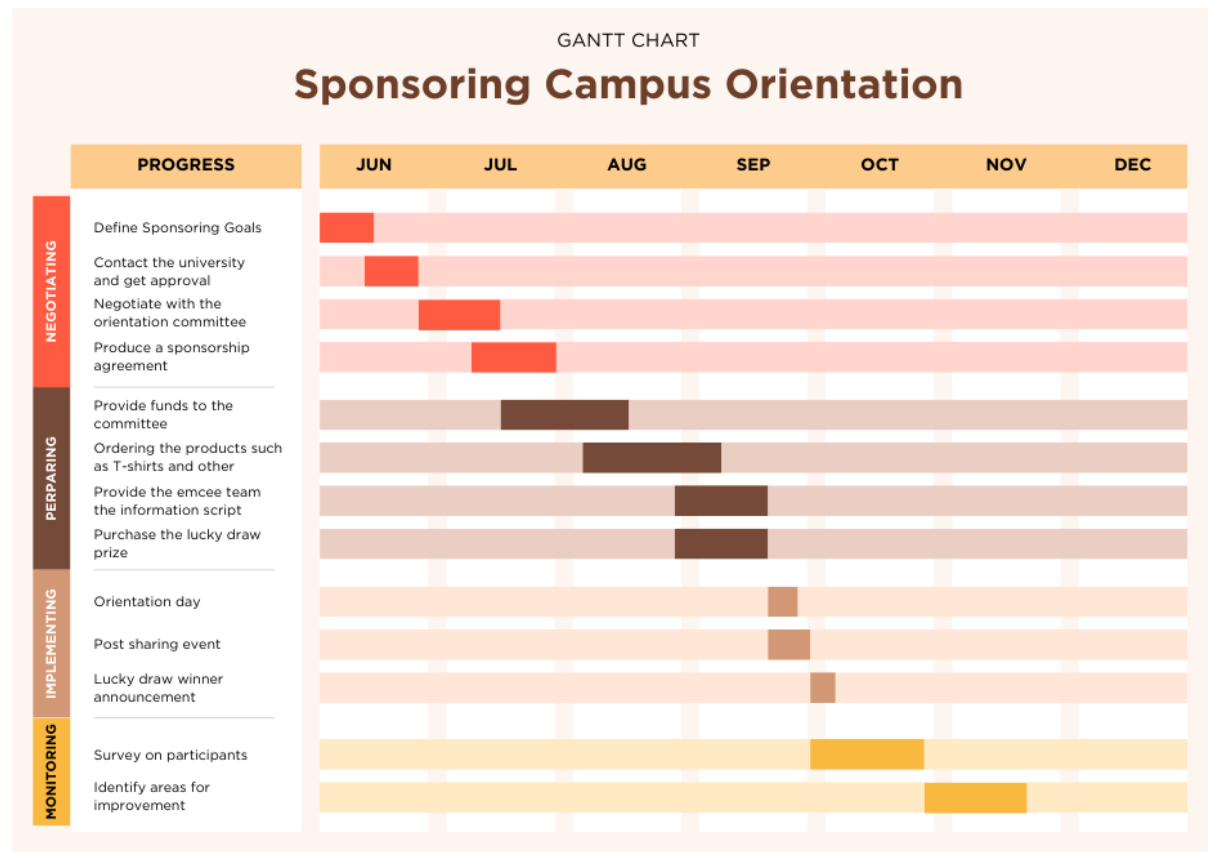
1. STRATEGIC ADVERTISING

1.1 Sponsoring Campus Orientation

We can help Eastspring strengthen its public image and recognition by sponsoring campus events and exposing Eastspring to wider audiences. We can seek sponsoring opportunities in the campus that maximise the benefit. For example, we can negotiate a sponsorship in university orientation to have Eastspring brand exposure throughout the event, possibly sponsoring the orientation T-shirt printed with the company name and logo. We can also exploit user-generated content through a reciprocal advertising strategy. For instance, we can host a lucky draw during the sponsored event where participants can get a chance to win the prizes

by sharing Eastspring's social media posts on their account. Consequently, the students will also become Eastspring's publicists by promoting Eastspring on social media.

Initiatives and Estimated Budget:



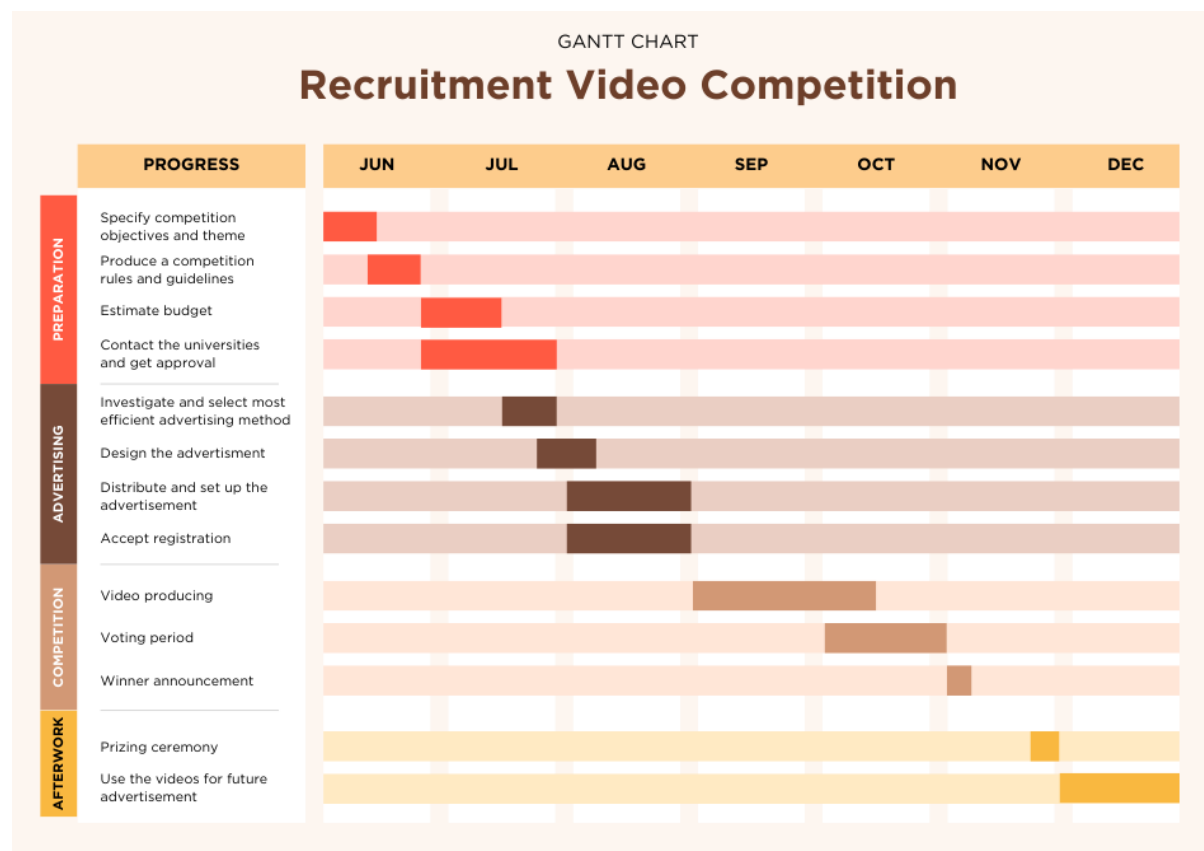
No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Sponsoring campus orientation.	20,000
2.	Lucky draw prize pool for reciprocal advertising.	8,000
Total Estimated Cost		28,000

1.2 Recruitment Video Competition

Furthermore, tapping into the advertising and marketing talents in the universities can contribute to better advertising methods that fit the preferences of youth at lower costs. Students

understand their peers better than anyone else. Therefore, they can produce a more customised strategy to help Eastspring attract youth candidates' attention. Specifically, we can host a nationwide or campus recruitment video competition requiring participants to create a short video showcasing Eastspring UTC's job description, benefits, flexibility, and career path development opportunities. The team with the highest reach, impressions, view time, and viewer votes are the winners. The prize should be lucrative enough to motivate more participants to reveal their creativity and strive to maximise audiences.

Initiatives and Estimated Budget:

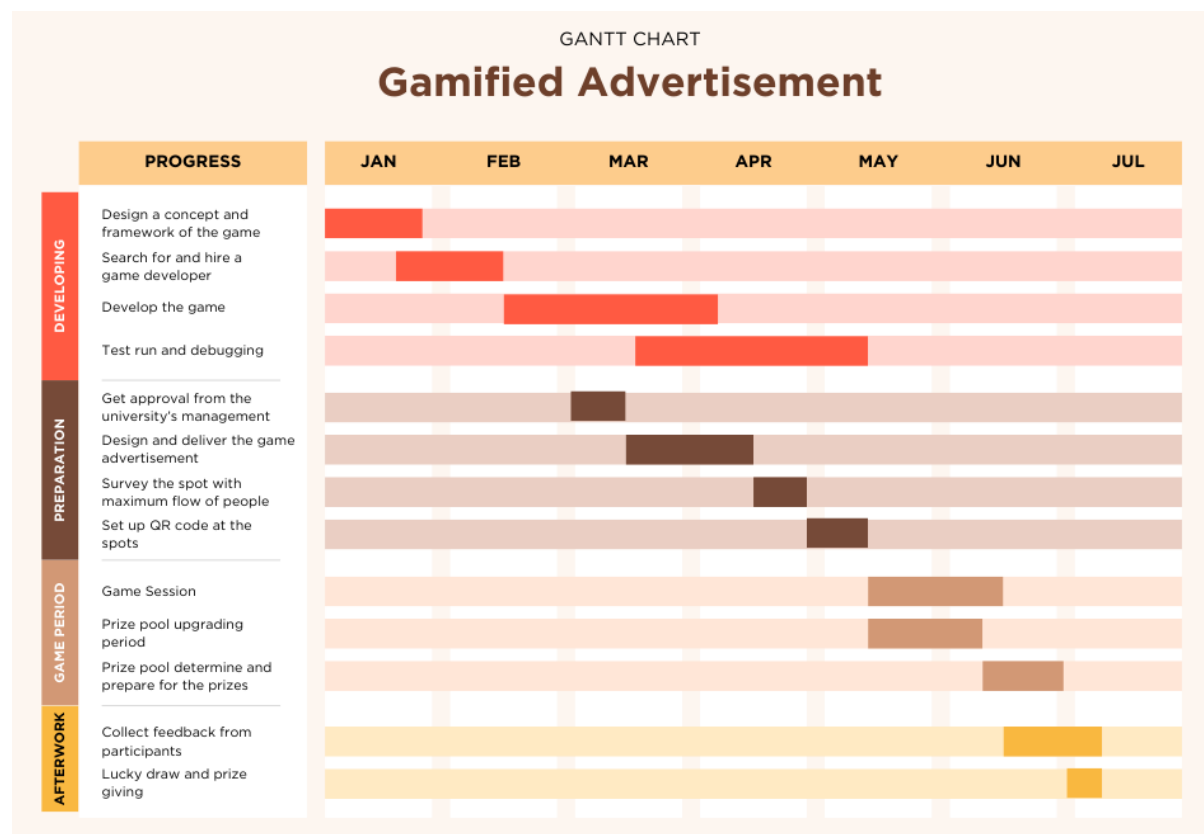


No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Advertisements on the competition	2,000
2.	Competition prize - 1st: RM10,000, 1st runner-up: RM5,000, 2nd runner-up: RM2,500, excellent award: RM1,000 x5	12,500
Total Estimated Cost		14,500

1.3 Gamified Advertisement

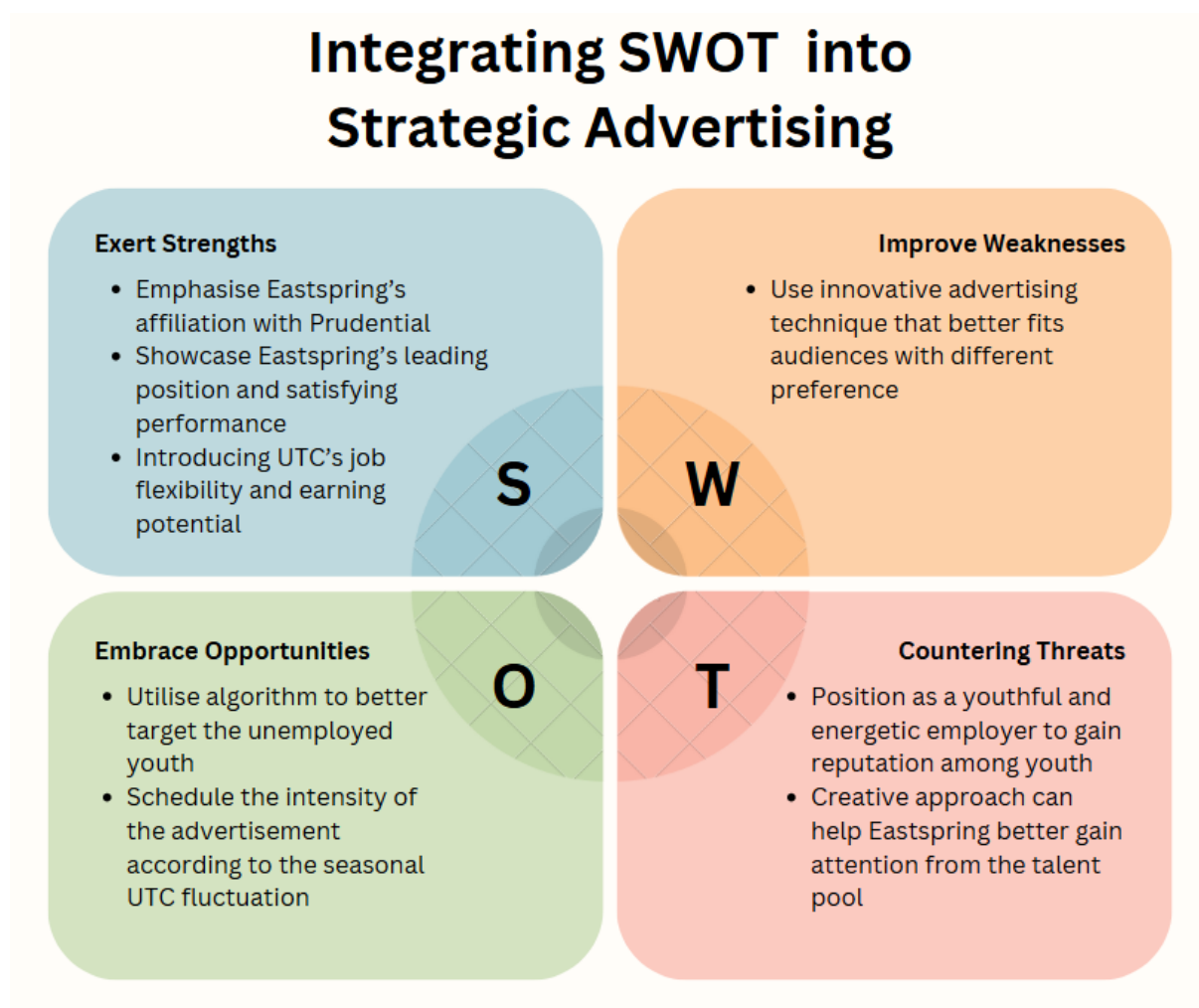
Another advertising strategy is to gamify the advertisement. We can work with the university or external coding experts to design a UTC job simulation mini-game. The game can be a point-collecting system where participants will answer the MCQ using the hints provided through QR codes distributed around the campus. The game tested the participant's understanding of Eastspring and the role of a UTC. When the participant answers the question correctly, he earns a point, and the higher the point, the more likely he will be chosen as the lucky draw winner. We can also include a sharing incentive where participants can earn extra points by sharing the game. The lucky draw prize pool follows an upgrading scale where the more participants there are, the more luxurious the prizes.

Initiatives and Estimated Budget:



No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Game design charges (This game can be reused by just changing the question base)	30,000
2.	Advertisement on the game	2,000
3.	Lucky draw prizes	10,000
Total Estimated Cost		42,000

SWOT Consideration to Include in Strategic Advertising:



Total Estimated Budget:

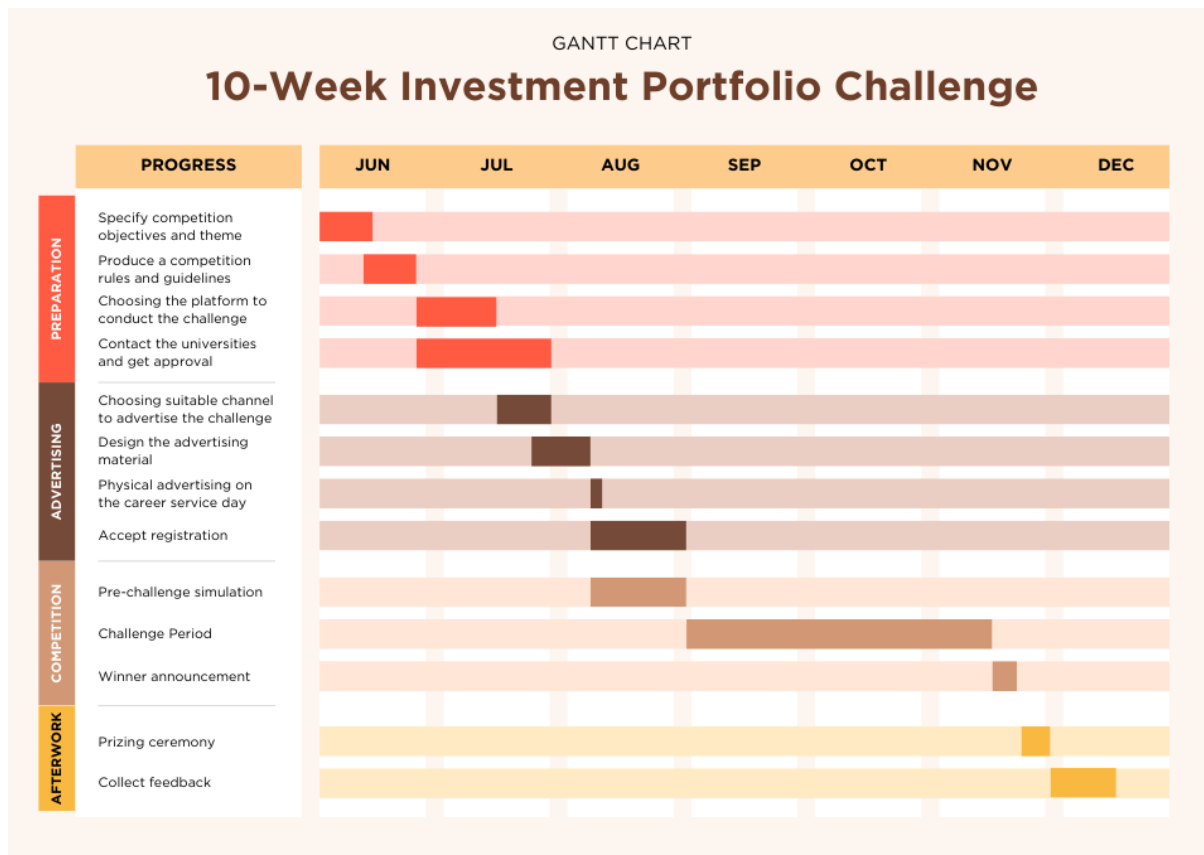
No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Sponsoring campus orientation	28,000
2.	Recruitment video competition	14,500
3.	Gamify advertisement	42,000
Total Estimated Cost		84,500

2. CAREER SERVICE PROMOTION

A career services promotion strategy can be hosted to attract fresh and future graduates to explore Eastspring's UTC careers. The promotion can be organised in collaboration with the university's Career Services Office and student clubs to maximise outreach and participation. They can help deliver brochures about UTCs' potential earnings, training pathways, and career growth opportunities. Besides, experienced consultants can be invited to speak about their journeys and demonstrate the usage of the Eastspring app.

To make the career fair more attractive, we can conduct a "10-Week Investment Portfolio Challenge," in which a team of 4-6 students is given a hypothetical sum of RM1,000,000 to perform a trading simulation. This challenge allows participants to experience the practical aspects of investment management while fostering interest in the financial industry. By the end of the challenge, the top 3 best-performing teams will be rewarded with attractive prizes and internship opportunities at Eastspring.

Initiatives:



Another interactive activity is the Spin-the-Wheel quiz, which includes finance-related questions or scenarios to create a fun and educational environment for the event. Participants spin the wheel and answer a random question. If they answer the quiz correctly, they can receive some special prizes. Furthermore, career fairs allow students to meet and network with experienced consultants or recruiters. In this case, we will conduct a Q&A session where students gain deeper insights into the role of UTC through the career fair.

Besides that, Eastspring can introduce a four-week micro-internship program during the career fair, which allows students to register their interests directly on the spot. This short-term program provides students real-world exposure to finance and consulting and the flexibility to gain practical experience during their semester break. The micro-internship should also provide the opportunity for remote working to enable students to work from their hometown during semester break. Granting the students the chance to experience the role of UTC can help Eastspring discover potential talent more efficiently and accurately.

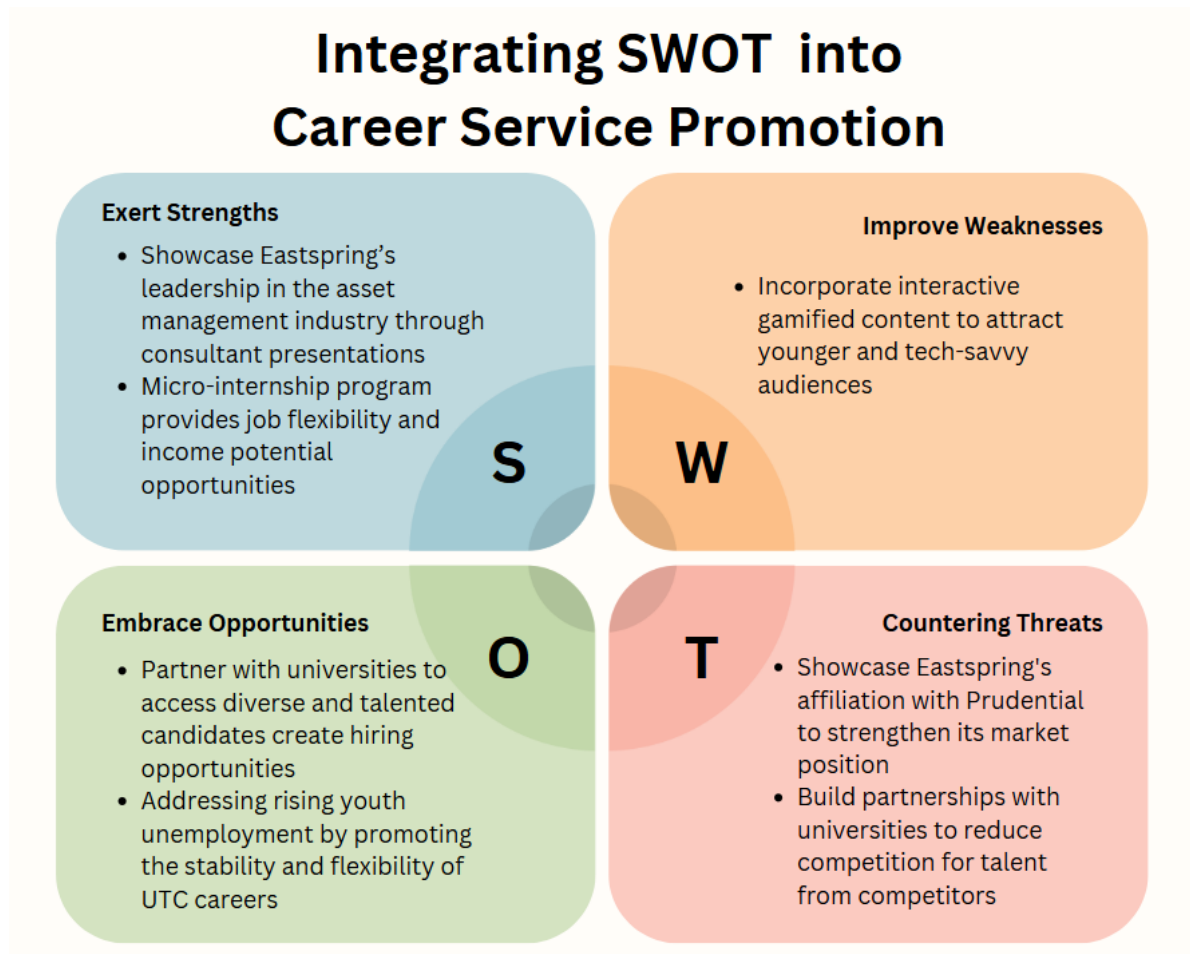
Time Schedule and Estimated Budget:

Career Services Promotion Schedule

Time	Activity
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Registration and distribution of brochures
9:30 - 10:30 AM	Opening ceremony and speech given by experienced consultant
10:30 - 12:00 PM	Demonstration session on tools and platforms commonly used by unit trust consultants
12:00 - 1:00 PM	Lunch break
1:00 - 2:00 PM	Introduce the "10-Week Investment Portfolio Challenge"
2:00 - 2:30 PM	Spin-the-Wheel Quiz activity
2.30 - 3.00 PM	Introduce the four-week micro-internship
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Ending speech and photo session

No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Setup and rental of hall and discussion areas	5,000
2.	Brochures, posters, and promotional materials	1,000
3.	Inviting experienced consultants	10,000
4.	Lunch for 200 participants (estimated)	4,000
5.	Prizes for "10-Week Investment Portfolio Challenge" (winners)	20,000
6.	Small prize and giveaways for quizzes and Q&A sessions	2,000
7.	Micro-internship salary (10 interns x RM1,000)	10,000
Total Estimated Cost		52,000

SWOT Consideration to Include in Career Service Promotion:



3. COMPANY VISITATION AND WORKSHOP

3.1 Company visitation

A company tour is an effective way to create or enhance Eastspring's image among university students. The tour is scheduled to take place four times a year. To improve the quality of each tour, the number of participants should not exceed 30 people, and it is recommended that two tour guides lead the group.

The tour guides will share the company's history, vision, operations, work environment, and organizational culture. To promote engagement, interactive sessions, such as a personality test, will be included to ensure that all participants feel included. An interactive Q&A session with attractive prizes can also help refresh participants' knowledge about Eastspring. There should

be at least 15 prizes available, ensuring that more than half of the participants are rewarded, with each prize valued at a minimum of RM 50. This approach will help create a corporate image of generosity and high profitability among participants.

Furthermore, the participants should be introduced to the availability of training workshops during the tour to demonstrate that Eastspring is committed to the continuous development and success of newcomers.

Time Schedule and Estimated Budget:

Company Visitation Schedule	
Time	Activity
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Arrival
9:30 - 10:00 AM	Welcome speech and ice breaking session
10:00 - 10:30 PM	Office Tour
10:30 - 12:00 PM	Interactive Event: Personality test and sharing session
12:00 - 1:30 PM	Lunch Break
1:30 - 2:30 PM	Briefing about company history, vision, operation, culture, and environment
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Q&A session
3:00 - 4:00 PM	Introduction of the training workshop
4:00 - 5:00 PM	Return to the university

No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Travelling expenses via one bus	750
2.	Hiring two tour guides	2,000
3.	Booking a discussion room for interactive events	1,000
4.	Lunch provision	1,000
5.	Prizes in Q&A session	1,000
Total Estimated Cost		5,750

3.2 Training Workshop

Young people should receive training workshops focused on industrial knowledge and practices. These workshops are essential for attracting competent and qualified individuals to join the company, as they demonstrate Eastspring's commitment to recruiting, developing, and retaining employees. According to research by IDfy, Generation Z values learning and growth opportunities more than salary increases [4]. In light of this, Eastspring should organize a training workshop for university students to garner the interest and support of Generation Z.

The workshop is planned to occur one month after each company tour. Two skilled trainers will share their career experiences and highlight key elements necessary for securing a position to a group of 30 participants. Additionally, a brainstorming session can be held to identify, analyse, discuss, and address recent challenges faced by Eastspring. This exercise will enhance participants' problem-solving skills, which are crucial for their roles. Furthermore, mock consultation training is recommended to develop communication skills and boost confidence.

For the brainstorming, training, and mock consultation sessions, participants will be divided into two subgroups 15, with one trainer assigned to each group to ensure efficiency and full engagement. Outstanding participants will be offered attractive prizes and internships.

[4] <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/gen-z-dont-want-your-money-idfy-lferf/>

Time Schedule and Estimated Budget:

Training Workshop Schedule	
Time	Activity
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Arrival
9:30 - 10:00 AM	Welcome speech and ice breaking session
10:00 - 11:00 PM	Sharing session by outstanding UTC
11:00 - 12:00 PM	Brainstorming on recent topics or case studies
12:00 - 1:00 PM	Lunch Break
1:00 - 2:30 PM	Consultation training tips
2:30 - 4:00 PM	Mock consultation
4:00 - 4:30 PM	Prizing ceremony
4:30 - 5:00 PM	Ending speech and photo session

No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Travelling expenses via one bus	750
2.	Hiring two trainers (Can be outstanding PAMB and PBTB agents)	3,000
3.	Booking a discussion room for interactive events	1,000
4.	Lunch provision	1,000
5.	Prizes in Q&A session	2,000
Total Estimated Cost		7,750

SWOT Consideration in Company Visitation and Training Workshop:

Integrating SWOT into Company Visitation and Training Workshop

Exert Strengths

- The company visit highlighted Eastspring's first-class working environment as one of the leading asset management firms.
- Training workshop can showcase the flexible job structure

S

Improve Weaknesses

- A training workshop is more attractive to younger individuals who are tech-savvy.
- A training workshop can attract students from diverse backgrounds to explore a career as a UTC.

W

Embrace Opportunities

- Invited PAMB and PBTB talent workshop trainers may show interest in joining Eastspring.
- Workshops and visits can motivate students to plan their career paths before they become unemployed.

O

Countering Threats

- Company visit can strengthen networking and improve reputation among talented individuals
- Exclusive training workshop can provide a better position for Eastspring to attract talent

T

Total Estimated Budget:

No.	Particulars	Estimate Cost (RM)
1.	Company visitation	5,750
2.	Training workshop	7,750
Total Estimated Cost		13,500

4. STUDENT AMBASSADOR & MENTORSHIP PROGRAMME

4.1 Student Ambassador Programme

The Youth Ambassador Programme appoints selected students as representatives within their universities to bridge the student community with Eastspring Investment. We assisted Eastspring in designing the requirements, activity framework, evaluation criteria, and incentive structure. Eastspring will handle the screening process to select talented students.

Requirements:

No.	Requirements
1.	Applicants must be enrolled as university students during the application period
2.	Should have at least 12 months until graduation
3.	Knowledgeable & have a strong interest in the financial markets
4.	Must be familiar with the responsibilities of a unit trust consultant
5.	Minimum CGPA of 2.5 & higher
6.	Active involvement in extracurricular activities or university clubs/societies

Activity framework and evaluation criteria:

No.	Activities	Points
1.	Promote Eastspring Investment unit trust consultancy in Social Media	5
2.	Social media engagements with team members	5
3.	Organise and speak at a bonding session with at least 10 students	10
4.	Organise a mentorship workshop at the university (speakers from Eastspring Investment or Prudential)	10
5.	Top 5 finalists in Eastspring Investment Business Case Challenge	10-20

6.	Lead and organise university students from business & finance clubs to participate in the Eastspring Youth Summit	15
7.	Others (ambassador's own initiatives upon approval)	10-15
The total score is used to evaluate the ambassador's performance		Total

Incentive structure:

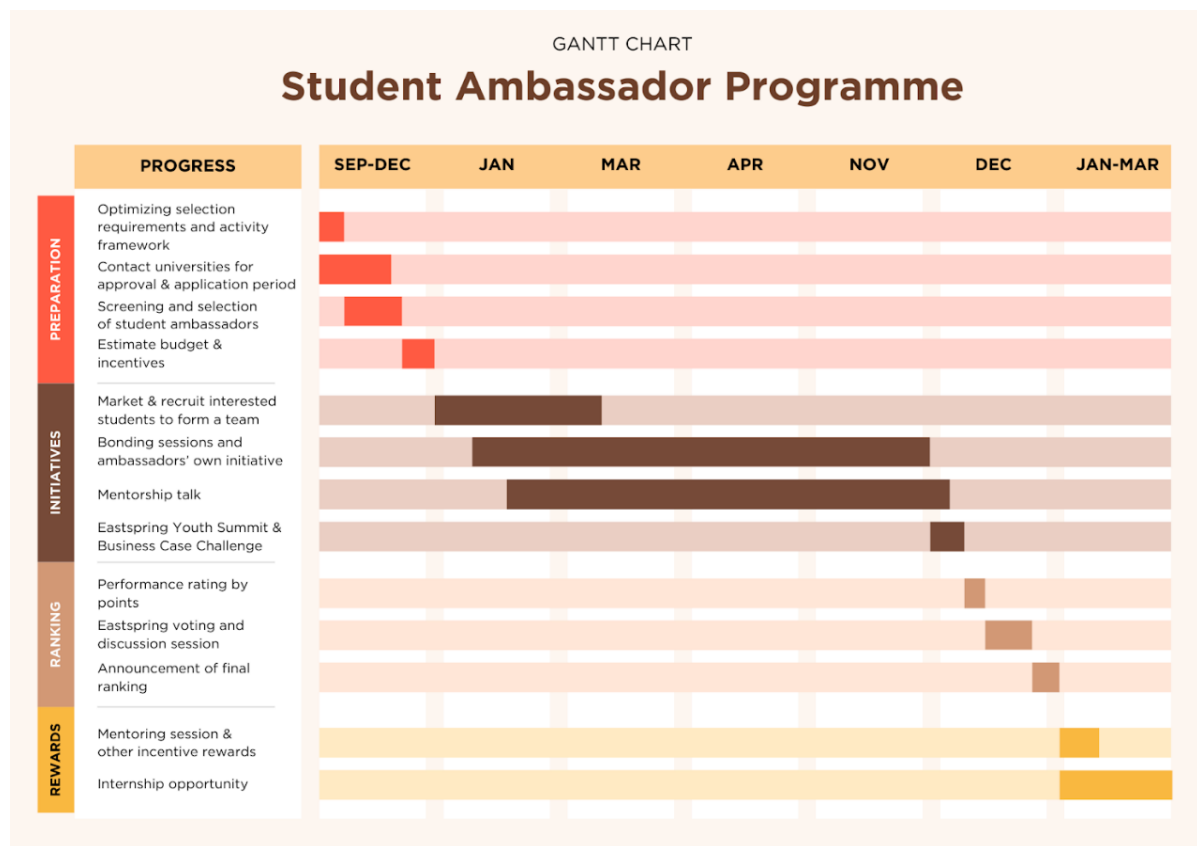
No.	Incentives
1.	Association with globally renowned companies, Eastspring Investment Berhad & Prudential Asia
2.	One mentoring session with an industry professional (awarded to outstanding ambassadors with the highest score)
3.	Networking opportunities
4.	Opportunity to experience being a real unit trust agent for a short period (simulation)
5.	Internship opportunities (awarded to outstanding ambassadors)
6.	Monetary rewards for recruiting agents who secure clients for the company

Initiatives and Estimated Budget:

No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost (RM)
1.	Budget for the ambassador's initiative (RM1,000 for each university's ambassador, estimated 15 universities)	15,000
2.	Monetary rewards as incentives	2,000
3.	Internship opportunities (3 months)	3,000
4.	Unit trust agent simulation	1,000

5.	Labour costs incurred during the screening process	5,000
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Total Estimated Cost	26,000
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4.2 Mentorship Talk

Once selected, student ambassadors will promote, market, and recruit students interested in pursuing UTC careers. They will lead and organise bonding sessions and mentorship programmes for all university students. Licensed unit trust agents will be invited to share various topics, such as their experience as UTCs and the intricacies of the job. PAMB and PBTB agents can also mentor students on sales, marketing, and communication skills to help them cultivate the ability to secure clients. These quarterly mentorship sessions will be conducted through physical university talks or online workshops. The fees can also serve as an additional income stream for licensed unit trust agents who participate as mentors, providing further incentives for their involvement.

Time Schedule and Estimated Budget:

Mentorship Talk Schedule

Time	Activity
7.00 – 7.30 PM	Arrival of participants & speaker to a lecture hall
7.30 – 9.30 PM	Mentorship talk
9.30 – 10.00 PM	Present certification of appreciation & group photo-taking

No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost (RM)
1.	Speaker invitation fee – held quarterly (RM800 each time)	3,200
2.	Participant fee (RM10 x 40 x 4 quarters)	(1,600)
Total Estimated Cost		1,600

Students from non-finance backgrounds who do not fulfil the requirements to become licensed agents can join teams formed by student ambassadors to gain exposure to the industry. By participating in these teams, they can overcome the challenge of high qualification standards by acquiring skills such as financial literacy, wealth management, and communication. This approach lowers entry barriers and makes the profession more accessible to potential talents from non-finance backgrounds.

4.3 Eastspring Youth Summit

Student ambassadors can collaborate with business associations and finance-related clubs in their universities to expand the programme's reach. This collaboration will culminate in the annual Eastspring Youth Summit. During this event, ambassadors, their teams and students from different universities will gather to exchange ideas, share best practices, network and

enhance recruitment strategies for unit trust agents. Best-performing UTCs and top-performing PAMB and PBTB agents will be invited as guest speakers to provide inspiration and practical advice. Eastspring Investment can invite other companies to set up career booths and hold a career fair, generating additional revenue through booth fees.

Time Schedule and Estimated Budget:

Eastspring Youth Summit Schedule	
Time	Activity
7.00 – 8.00 AM	Booth setup period
8.30 – 9.30 AM	Arrival of guests & participants (Registration)
9.30 – 10.00 AM	Keynote speakers (Welcome and opening address)
10.00 – 11.30 PM	Speaker 1 session
11.30 – 1.00 PM	Lunch break (networking and booth visitation)
1.00 – 2.30 PM	Speaker 2 session
2.30 – 3.30 PM	Case study and pitching session (only university students)
3.30 – 3.50 PM	Small prize ceremony
3.50 – 4.20 PM	Coffee break (networking and booth visitation)
4.20 – 5.50 PM	Speaker 3 session
5.50 – 6.20 PM	Keynote speaker (Closing address by top management from Eastspring or Prudential)
6.20 – 6.40 PM	Ending speech and photo session

No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost (RM)
1.	Bus transportation fees - only provided to universities with ambassadors and significant participation from business and finance clubs (RM800 per uni, estimated 15 universities)	12,000

2.	Event venue rental fees	10,000
3.	Lunch - provided to all attendees (RM10 per person, estimated total of 1000 participants)	10,000
4.	Speaker fees (RM1500 per speaker, total 3 speakers)	4,500
5.	Participating fees (RM15 per pax, 1000 total participants)	(15,000)
6.	Booth rental fees (RM500 per booth, estimated 20 booths)	(10,000)
Total Estimated Cost		11,500

At the same time, this event will address youth unemployment by encouraging graduates, particularly unemployed individuals, to participate. These graduates can submit their resumes and explore career opportunities with Eastspring, allowing the company to tap into a talent pool from the youth unemployment market.

The programme should avoid direct comparisons with insurance agents to attract students to the unit trust profession despite its lower commissions. Instead, ambassadors will position UTC as a distinct career path with significant untapped market potential that offers opportunities in an emerging market with lower competition than the saturated insurance sector. Ambassadors can highlight the potential for growth, commissions, and passive income, attracting students seeking rewarding careers.

These initiatives and events will increase Eastspring Investment's reputation and serve as a form of professional advertising. By focusing on professionalism and avoiding tactics that could undermine its credibility as a reputable asset management company, Eastspring can effectively position itself as a leader in recruitment and financial expertise. The success of this programme can also provide insights into whether to expand initiatives further, ensuring a sustainable and impactful recruitment strategy.

SWOT Consideration in Student Ambassador and Mentorship Programme:

Integrating SWOT into Student Ambassador and Mentorship Programme

Exert Strengths

- Utilizes affiliated connections by engaging licensed UTCs and insurance agents
- Showcases expertise and resources within the industry
- Introduces students to the concept of flexible career opportunities

S

Improve Weaknesses

- Establishing UTC as a unique and emerging career path to prevent direct comparisons
- Organic promotion boosts recognition among students and the community.
- Non-finance students to join ambassador-led teams to gain financial skills, lowering barriers

W

Embrace Opportunities

- PAMB and PBTB agents are invited as speakers to give mentorship talks and share their experience at the annual event
- Providing opportunities for unemployed youth at the annual event

O

Countering Threats

- Diverts focus from external factors, highlighting the profession's long-term potential.
- Building competitive advantage by hosting annual event & collaborating with universities
- Broadening talent pool by including non-finance backgrounds talents

T

Total Estimated Budget:

No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost (RM)
1.	Student ambassador programme	26,000
2.	Mentorship talk (15 universities – RM1600 x 15)	24,000
3.	Annual event - Eastspring Youth Summit	11,500
Total Estimated Cost		61,500

4. CONCLUSION

In conclusion, the proposed initiatives strategically align with Eastspring's goal of enhancing its recruitment strategy and public image among the youth demographic. By leveraging innovative approaches such as campus sponsorships, recruitment video competitions, gamified advertisements, and a robust student ambassador program, Eastspring can effectively capture the interest and engagement of its target audience. Complementary strategies, including career fairs, mentorship talks, and company visitations, further solidify Eastspring's commitment to fostering professional growth and expanding its agency force.

These efforts address the identified weaknesses and threats from the SWOT analysis and capitalise on emerging opportunities to strengthen Eastspring's competitive position in the Malaysian market. By focusing on meaningful engagement, professional branding, and targeted advertising, Eastspring has the potential to transform its recruitment approach into a sustainable and impactful model, ultimately driving growth and success in a competitive industry landscape.

Total Estimated Budget for all Initiatives:

No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost (RM)
1.	Strategic Advertising	82,500
2.	Career Service Promotion	52,000
3.	Company Visitation and Workshop x4 (held quarterly)	54,000
4.	Student Ambassador and Mentorship Programme	61,500
Total Estimated Cost		250,000

Net Word Count: 2,061 words

(Word count excluding tables, figures, and appendix)

APPENDIX

The appendix includes some alternative initiatives that can be considered but are being removed from the main content due to word count limitations.

Strategic Advertising - Influencer Marketing

Eastspring should pursue a marketing technique that better suits the preferences of the younger generations, such as using influencer marketing. The influencer should be those target audiences, which are undergraduate youth, to have better effectiveness in finding educated and talented candidates. These influencers may not have enough financial knowledge, but they can be an ambassador for building Eastspring's reputation. Besides, Eastspring can hire finance-related influencers with tech-savvy audiences to gain attention from those skilful talents. For example, they can promote the UTC job in their video to attract those eager to use their financial knowledge to earn sizable passive income.

